

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational A • 2026

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History

30 items (1 point each)

1. An article, an object, including any book, that one keeps constantly on hand is called a(n)
A) *de casibus*.
B) *deus ex machina*.
C) *dolce stil nuovo*.
D) *in medias res*.
E) *vade mecum*.
2. A short narrative detailing the particulars of an interesting episode or event, usually involving the life of an important person and having an element of truth to it is a(n)
A) anecdote.
B) chronicle.
C) fabliau.
D) legend.
E) romance.
3. The twentieth-century American author of *To Kill a Mockingbird* whose recently discovered short stories were published posthumously in an anthology titled *The Land of Sweet Forever* in October 2025 is
A) Willa Cather.
B) Harper Lee.
C) Carson McCullers.
D) Flannery O'Connor.
E) Edith Wharton.
4. The recipient of 1926 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for her collection *What's O'Clock* is
A) Gwendolyn Brooks.
B) Amy Lowell.
C) Marianne Moore.
D) Audrey Wurdemann.
E) Marya Zaturenska.
5. The name by which the early nineteenth-century English Romantics of Cumbria and Lancashire—William Wordsworth, Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Robert Southey, Charles Lamb, Mary Lamb, and Thomas De Quincey—came to be known is the
A) Cockney School.
B) Imagists.
C) Lake School.
D) Pre-Raphaelites.
E) Scriblerus Club.
6. **Not** a form of poetry considered to be a pattern poem is (the)
A) altar poem.
B) *carmen figuratum*.
C) figure poem.
D) rebus.
E) shaped verse.
7. In Greek mythology, the three sister goddesses, Aglaia, Euphrosyne, and Thalia, who confer elegance, beauty, charm, and joy on human beings, and nature are the
A) Furies.
B) Graces.
C) Humors.
D) Muses.
E) Worthies.
8. The recipient of the 1936 Nobel Prize for Literature for "the power, honesty and deep-felt emotions of his dramatic works, which embody an original concept of tragedy" is
A) Albert Camus.
B) T. S. Eliot.
C) André Gide.
D) Eugene O'Neill.
E) Harold Pinter.
9. Writing that reads the same from left to right and from right to left is called a(n)
A) acrostic.
B) boustrophedon.
C) palindrome.
D) reversal.
E) telestich.
10. The gathering of writers and thinkers, many of whom lived in a residential district near central London after which the group takes its name, counting among its membership Virginia Woolf, Lytton Strachey, E. M. Forster, John Maynard Keynes, and others, is the
A) Bloomsbury Group.
B) Bluestockings.
C) Fugitives.
D) Knickerbocker Group.
E) Scriblerus Club.

11. The term that describes a dramatic presentation that is characterized by a light, logical construction accompanied by apparent inevitability is
 - A) closet drama.
 - B) comedy of manners.
 - C) farce.
 - D) problem play.
 - E) well-made play.
12. A mistake in terms of a badly formed word that results from the violation of an accepted rule of linguistic morphology, often considered a "phrase not in use by the best persons," such as *goodest* for *best*, *hern* for *hers*, and *clomb* for *climbed*, is called a
 - A) barbarism.
 - B) Gongorism.
 - C) Malapropism.
 - D) Spoonerism.
 - E) Wellerism.
13. The author of short stories, screenplays, and novels, including *The Grapes of Wrath* for which he received the 1940 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, is
 - A) William Faulkner.
 - B) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
 - C) Ernest Hemingway.
 - D) Henry James.
 - E) John Steinbeck.
14. Writings or drawings that exaggerate certain qualities of a person—usually and especially, personal qualities—and often produces a ridiculous effect are known as
 - A) caricatures.
 - B) farces.
 - C) hoaxes.
 - D) limericks.
 - E) melodramas.
15. The period in English literature between the death of Queen Victoria and the beginning of the first World War that is characterized by a strong reaction to the propriety and conservatism of Victorianism is the
 - A) Augustan Age.
 - B) Caroline Age.
 - C) Edwardian Age.
 - D) Jacobean Age.
 - E) Victorian Age.
16. The American playwright whose plays offer characters representative of people found on the fringes of ordinary and conventional American life is
 - A) Lillian Hellman.
 - B) Arthur Miller.
 - C) Eugene O'Neill.
 - D) Neil Simon.
 - E) Thornton Wilder.
17. A group of attitudes (current in philosophical, religious, and artistic thought during and after World War II) that argues the inadequacies of human reason to explain the enigma of the universe as the basic philosophical question is
 - A) aestheticism.
 - B) existentialism.
 - C) expressionism.
 - D) impressionism.
 - E) nihilism.
18. **Not** a species of conversation, oral or written, that includes at least two characters speaking is (a)
 - A) apostrophe.
 - B) dialogue.
 - C) flyting.
 - D) repartee.
 - E) stichomythia.
19. Rhyme in which the rhyming stressed syllables are followed by an undifferentiated identical unstressed syllable such as *waken* and *forsaken* or *exciting* and *inviting* is
 - A) broken rhyme.
 - B) compound rhyme.
 - C) eye rhyme.
 - D) feminine rhyme.
 - E) masculine rhyme.
20. The term that embodies the application of principles of scientific (either biological or socioeconomic) determinism in literature, which, in turn, characterizes a literary movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, is
 - A) Darwinism.
 - B) meliorism.
 - C) naturalism.
 - D) objectivism.
 - E) surrealism.

21. The first English translation of Boethius' *Consolation of Philosophy*, the first history of the English people, the Venerable Bede's *Ecclesiastical History*, and poetry of an emphatically Christian nature, including Caedmon's "Song," represent the
 - A) Anglo-Norman Period.
 - B) Early Tudor Age.
 - C) Middle English Period.
 - D) Neoclassic Period.
 - E) Old English Period.
22. The idea that primitive human beings are naturally good and whatever evil they develop is the product of the corrupting action of civilization is represented by the term
 - A) barbarism.
 - B) hedonism.
 - C) humanism.
 - D) meliorism.
 - E) noble savage.
23. The late Elizabethan playwright whose thirty-nine or so comedies, tragedies, romances, and chronicle plays have entertained generations of theatre-goers worldwide is
 - A) Ben Jonson.
 - B) Thomas Kyd.
 - C) Christopher Marlowe.
 - D) William Shakespeare.
 - E) John Webster.
24. The nineteenth-century English poet who wrote the sonnet sequence *Sonnets from the Portuguese* and verse-novel *Aurora Leigh* is
 - A) Louisa May Alcott.
 - B) Elizabeth Barrett Browning.
 - C) Emily Dickinson.
 - D) Mary Lamb.
 - E) Christina Rossetti.
25. A narrative or tradition handed down from the past that is characterized by having something of the historical truth and relatively little of the supernatural is called (a/an)
 - A) anecdote.
 - B) folklore.
 - C) legend.
 - D) myth.
 - E) parable.
26. Classically, the employment of some unexpected and improbable incident to make things turn out right, and currently, any device whereby an author solves a difficult situation by a forced or contrived invention is
 - A) *coup de théâtre*.
 - B) *deus ex machina*.
 - C) *dolce stil nuovo*.
 - D) *in medias res*.
 - E) *scène à faire*.
27. **Not** a literary time period designating a grouping of years within the English Renaissance Period, which itself encompasses the sixteenth and three-fifths of the seventeenth centuries, is the
 - A) Augustan Age.
 - B) Early Tudor Age.
 - C) Elizabethan Age.
 - D) Caroline Age.
 - E) Jacobean Age.
28. The group of seventeenth-century English poets who revolted against the conventions of Elizabethan love poetry, in particular its reliance on the Petrarchan conceit, is the
 - A) Cavalier Poets.
 - B) Graveyard Poets.
 - C) Martian Poets.
 - D) Metaphysical Poets.
 - E) Spasmodic Poets.
29. The recipient of the Pulitzer Prize for Drama for the years 1920, 1922, 1928, and 1957 for plays which introduced realism to the American stage is
 - A) Edward Albee.
 - B) Horton Foote.
 - C) Arthur Miller.
 - D) Eugene O'Neill.
 - E) Tennessee Williams.
30. The period of literary beginnings in which the voices of Hugh Henry Brackenridge, Philip Freneau, Benjamin Franklin, Phillis Wheatley, Washington Irving, and Royall Tyler found expression is the
 - A) Colonial Period.
 - B) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
 - C) Realistic Period.
 - D) Revolutionary and Early National Period.
 - E) Romantic Period.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List

20 items (2 points each)

Items 31-35 are associated with Eugene O'Neill's *The Iceman Cometh*.

Items 36-42 are associated with Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird*.

Items 43-50 are associated with William Shakespeare's sonnets.

-
31. In Eugene O'Neill's *The Iceman Cometh*, the occupation that serves to characterize Theodore Hickman and the frequency of his appearance in Greenwich Village is
- A) alcohol company representative.
 - B) brassware trumpeter.
 - C) hardware drummer.
 - D) physician who specializes in the Wobblies.
 - E) pipe salesman.
32. The self-reflective "I was born condemned to be one of those who has to see all sides of a question" is shared with Don Parritt by
- A) Theodore Hickman.
 - B) Harry Hope.
 - C) Pat McGloin.
 - D) Chuck Morello.
 - E) Larry Slade
33. Slade's exclamation "Be God, it's a second feast of Belshazzar, with Hickey to do the writing on the wall!" features a
- A) biblical allusion.
 - B) classical allusion.
 - C) literary allusion.
 - D) pop cultural allusion.
 - E) sports allusion.
34. The source of the tension defining the relationship between Piet Wetjoen and Cecil Lewis is their participation in (the)
- A) Anglo-Aro War.
 - B) Bambatha Rebellion.
 - C) Boer War.
 - D) Crimean War.
 - E) World War I.
35. The shared pipedream of getting married and moving to a farm in New Jersey despite the probability of crickets "drivin' [them] nuts" belongs to
- A) Chuck and Cora.
 - B) Harry and Bess.
 - C) Larry and Rosa.
 - D) Rocky and Pearl.
 - E) Theodore and Evelyn.
36. In Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird*, the first grade teacher who is extremely concerned about how her students, especially Jean Louise Finch, are taught to read is
- A) Maudie Atkinson.
 - B) Mayella Ewell.
 - C) Caroline Fisher.
 - D) Alexandra Hancock.
 - E) Calpurnia Zeebo.
37. Explaining Atticus's two-week absence as a response to the "Governor[s being] eager to scrape a few barnacles off the ship of state" constitutes the narrator's use of
- A) chiasmus.
 - B) hyperbole.
 - C) litotes.
 - D) metaphor.
 - E) zeugma.
38. That which, arguably, serves as a poignant topical allusion appears in the narrator's recounting of the troubling subject matter of Cecil Jacob's
- A) current events presentation.
 - B) description of Boo Radley's back porch.
 - C) introductory remarks at the Halloween pageant.
 - D) summation of the prosecution's opening argument.
 - E) taunting the Finch siblings about Atticus's role.
39. "The most boring child I ever met," the one who gave Scout the "sensation of settling slowly to the bottom of the ocean," is
- A) Walter Cunningham, Jr.
 - B) Burris Ewell.
 - C) Jem Finch.
 - D) Francis Hancock.
 - E) Dill Harris.
40. The critical observation "Anybody who's brave enough to go up and touch the house hadn't oughta use a fishin' pole. Why don't you just knock the front door down?" is directed at
- A) Jem by Atticus.
 - B) Jem by Scout.
 - C) Dill by Jem.
 - D) Dill by Scout.
 - E) Scout by Atticus.

41. Scout's costume in the Mrs. Merriweather's Halloween pageant is a
 A) butterbean.
 B) cow.
 C) ham.
 D) peanut.
 E) pumpkin.
42. The narrator notes there was a time during which to have one's teeth pulled, or one's wagon fixed, or one's heart listened to, or one's money deposited, or one's soul saved, or one's mules vetted, one went to
 A) Finch's Landing.
 B) Maycomb.
 C) Meridian.
 D) Monroeville.
 E) Montgomery.
45. The dropping of a syllable as found in *feed'st* (line 6) and *mak'st* (12) to accommodate the meter is known as
 A) caesura.
 B) elision.
 C) enjambment.
 D) hiatus.
 E) metathesis.
46. The concept of quantity inherent in the word *increase* (line 1) and the references to both "famine" and "abundance" (7), followed by line 13's accusatory "glutton," constitute the sonnet's
 A) aesthetic distance.
 B) controlling image.
 C) dead metaphor.
 D) epic simile.
 E) pleonasm.

Items 43-46 refer to William Shakespeare's

[From fairest creatures we desire increase]

From fairest creatures we desire increase,
 That thereby beauty's rose might never die,
 But as the ripper should by time decease,
 His tender heir might bear his memory; 4
 But thou, contracted to thine own bright eyes,
 Feed'st thy light's flame with self-substantial fuel,
 Making a famine where abundance lies,
 Thyself thy foe, to thy sweet self too cruel. 8
 Thou that art now the world's fresh ornament
 And only herald to the gaudy spring,
 Within thine own bud buriest thy content,
 And, tender churl, mak'st waste in niggarding. 12
 Pity the world, or else this glutton be,
 To eat the world's due, by the grave and thee.

43. In Shakespeare's Sonnet 1, the phrase "beauty's rose might never die" (line 2) is a(n)
 A) apologue.
 B) kenning.
 C) metaphor.
 D) simile.
 E) tautology.
44. The speaker's addressing "tender churl" (line 12) and "thou" (5) points to this poem's being a(n)
 A) apostrophe.
 B) aside.
 C) harangue.
 D) incantation.
 E) soliloquy.

Items 47-50 refer to William Shakespeare's

[When in the chronicle of wasted time]

When in the chronicle of wasted time
 I see descriptions of the fairest wights,
 And beauty making beautiful old rhyme
 In praise of ladies dead and lovely knights, 4
 Then, in the blazon of sweet beauty's best,
 Of hand, of foot, of lip, of eye, of brow,
 I see their antique pen would have express'd
 Even such a beauty as you master now. 8
 So all their praises are but prophecies
 Of this our time, all you prefiguring;
 And, for they look'd but with divining eyes,
 They had not skill enough your worth to sing: 12
 For we, which now behold these present days,
 Have eyes to wonder, but lack tongues to praise.

47. The iambic meter of Sonnet 106's line 6 is maintained by dropping the expected conjunction, an instance of
 A) amphiboly.
 B) anaphora.
 C) asyndeton.
 D) polysyndeton.
 E) tautology.
48. Line 3's *beauty* and *beautiful* being in close proximity is an occurrence of
 A) merism.
 B) pleonasm.
 C) polyhyphenation.
 D) polyptoton.
 E) polysyndeton.

49. The reordering of the usual phrasing of an idea in order to accommodate a metrical pattern as found in line 4's "In praise of ladies dead" and line 12's "They had not skill enough" is known as
- elision.
 - inversion.
 - metathesis.
 - plote.
 - truncation.
50. The effectiveness of "For we [. . .] / Have eyes to wonder, but lack tongues to praise" (lines 13-14) is based on the substitution of a name of an object for a word closely associated with that object, a trope known as
- ambiguity.
 - chiasmus.
 - hyperbole.
 - litotes.
 - metonymy.
52. The melopoeic dissonance characterizing all of the poem's end rhymes—a type of rhyming that reflects the emotional dissonance of youthful innocence in the face of war—is known as
- consonance rhyme.
 - feminine rhyme.
 - identical rhyme.
 - leonine rhyme.
 - sfumato.
53. Thematically, the title relies on an ironic allusion to G. B. Shaw's use of Virgil's famous "Of arms and the man I sing"; thus and additionally, the title suggests that handling weapons is not a natural aspect of preparation for adulthood; this is especially clear in
- lines 1-4.
 - lines 5-6.
 - lines 7-8.
 - lines 9-10.
 - lines 9-12.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism

15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to Wilfred Owen's

Arms and the Boy

Let the boy try along this bayonet-blade
How cold steel is, and keen with hunger of blood;
Blue with all malice, like a madman's flash;
And thinly drawn with famishing for flesh. 4

Lend him to stroke these blind, blunt bullet-heads
Which long to muzzle in the hearts of lads.
Or give him cartridges of fine zinc teeth,
Sharp with the sharpness of grief and death. 8

For his teeth seem for laughing round an apple.
There lurk no claws behind his fingers supple;
And God will grow no talons at his heels,
Nor antlers through the thickness of his curls. 12

51. Wilfred Owen's treatment in "Arms and the Boy" of the bayonet, the bullets, and the cartridges develops its power through
- affective fallacy.
 - hyperbole.
 - metaphor.
 - paraphrase.
 - personification.
54. The effectiveness of line 3's imagery turns on a(n)
- antithesis.
 - conceit.
 - metaphor.
 - paradox.
 - simile.
55. In contrast to the majority of the poem's end-rhyming pairs, the end rhyme of lines 9 and 10 is
- feminine rhyme.
 - leonine rhyme.
 - macaronic rhyme.
 - masculine rhyme.
 - triple rhyme.
56. The form of Mckeithan's poem is the
- haiku.
 - lai.
 - tanka.
 - triolet.
 - senryu.

Item 56 refers to Oliver Mckeithan's

homage to a Japanese verse form

politicians talk
we can't believe what they say
but still vote for them

Items 57-60 refer to Percy Bysshe Shelley's

Ozymandias

I met a traveller from an antique land,
 Who said—"Two vast and trunkless legs of stone
 Stand in the desert. . . . Near them, on the sand,
 Half sunk a shattered visage lies, whose frown, 4
 And wrinkled lip, and sneer of cold command,
 Tell that its sculptor well those passions read
 Which yet survive, stamped on these lifeless things,
 The hand that mocked them, and the heart that fed;
 And on the pedestal, these words appear: 9
 My name is Ozymandias, King of Kings;
 Look on my Works, ye Mighty, and despair!
 Nothing beside remains. Round the decay 12
 Of that colossal Wreck, boundless and bare
 The lone and level sands stretch far away."

57. The repetition of sibilant sounds **across** the syllables of line 4 of Shelley's sonnet is an example of
- A) assonance.
 - B) consonance.
 - C) dissonance.
 - D) sigmatism.
 - E) truncation.
58. The reordering of the normal order of sentence elements in line 6 of "Ozymandias" is known as
- A) abridgment.
 - B) inversion.
 - C) metathesis.
 - D) ornamentalism.
 - E) reversal.
59. The theme is found in the admonitory observation
- A) antiques are not a good investment.
 - B) inscriptions last longer than visages.
 - C) power is fleeting.
 - D) sculptors stamp the life out of things.
 - E) stone carvings do not last forever.
60. Lines 4 through 8 reflect the persona's
- A) ability to read ancient carvings.
 - B) inability to rhyme every other line.
 - C) interest in ruined artifacts.
 - D) recognition of the sculptor's skill.
 - E) revisiting lifeless things as a hobby.

Two Horses

On a warm night in June
 I went to the lake, got on all fours,
 and drank like an animal. Two horses
 came up beside me to drink as well. 4
 This is amazing, I thought, but who will believe it?
 The horses eyed me from time to time, snorting
 and nodding. I felt the need to respond, so I snorted, too,
 but haltingly, as though not really wanting to be heard. 8
 The horses must have sensed that I was holding back.
 They moved slightly away. Then I thought they might
 have known me
 in another life—the one in which I was a poet.
 They might have even read my poems, for back then, 12
 in that shadowy time when our eagerness knew no bounds,
 we changed styles almost as often as there were days in
 the year.

61. The speaker's reflection on his former life suggests, perhaps, that poetry is
- A) difficult, like the language of horses, to understand.
 - B) the language of the Houyhnhnms.
 - C) a recognizably natural, organic language.
 - D) a summer night-inspired activity.
 - E) understood better by animals.
62. The auditory imagery found in "snorting" (line 6) is an example of (a)
- A) amphigory.
 - B) cacophony.
 - C) consonance.
 - D) nonce word.
 - E) onomatopoeia.
63. The poem's operative simile occurs in
- A) line 14.
 - B) line 11.
 - C) line 9.
 - D) line 6.
 - E) line 3.
64. The form of Strand's poem is
- A) beast fable.
 - B) blank verse.
 - C) fourteenier.
 - D) free verse.
 - E) sonnet.

Items 61-64 refer to Mark Strand's "Two Horses"

!!!!!!!!!!!!!!one more item on the next page!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

65. Isaac Newton
Was quite astute on
The subject of gravity's pull
After that apple made him thoughtful.

The poetic form of this quatrain is the

- A) clerihew.
- B) limerick.
- C) madrigal.
- D) pantoum.
- E) rebus.

Required Tie-Breaking Essay

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook's* notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read William Shakespeare's "[Why didst thou promise such a beauteous day]," and discuss the speaker's change in attitude to whom he is speaking as it appears in the closing couplet

[Why didst thou promise such a beauteous day]

Why didst thou promise such a beauteous day
And make me travel forth without my cloak,
To let base clouds o'ertake me in my way,
Hiding thy brav'ry in their rotten* smoke?
'Tis not enough that through the cloud thou break,
To dry the rain on my storm-beaten face.
For no man well of such a salve* can speak
That heals the wound and cures not the disgrace.
Nor can thy shame give physic* to my grief;
Though thou repent, yet I have still the loss.
The offender's sorrow lends but weak relief
To him that bears the strong offense's cross.
Ah, but those tears are pearl which thy love sheds,*
And they are rich, and ransom all ill deeds.

4 clouds were thought
to be a source of the
plague
healing ointment
8 healing relief
12 pronounced sheeds

DO NOT DISTRIBUTE THIS **KEY** TO STUDENTS BEFORE OR DURING THE CONTEST.

UIL Literary Criticism
Invitational A • 2026

line arrows up ➔

1.	E	493
2.	A	26
3.	B	
4.	B	604
5.	C	268
6.	D	401
7.	B	221
8.	D	599
9.	C	347
10.	A	61
11.	E	501
12.	A	50
13.	E	602
14.	A	74
15.	C	165
16.	C	
17.	B	188
18.	A	37
19.	D	196
20.	C	315
21.	E	335
22.	E	324
23.	D	
24.	B	562
25.	C	269
26.	B	137
27.	A	173
28.	D	296
29.	D	607
30.	D	410

31.	C	19; 4
32.	E	29
33.	A	105
34.	C	3; 40 ff
35.	A	87
36.	C	18
37.	D	132; 294
38.	A	280; 14
39.	D	92
40.	B	53
41.	C	289
42.	B	148
43.	C	294
44.	A	37
45.	B	167
46.	B	198
47.	C	44
48.	D	372
49.	B	257
50.	E	298
51.	E	361
52.	A	107
53.	E	
54.	E	445
55.	A	196
56.	E	438
57.	D	
58.	B	257
59.	C	
60.	D	
61.	C	
62.	E	337
63.	E	
64.	D	209
65.	A	92

FOLD

along the **three**
longitudinal
lines for ease
in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective
scores should not be altered to
reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1
are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2
are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3
are worth two points each.

DO NOT
mark (cross out)
actual **LETTER** answer;
mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer
to the *Handbook 12e*,

W. W. Norton
The Iceman Cometh,

HarperPerennial
To Kill a Mockingbird,
and

Folger Library
Shakespeare's Sonnets, Poems

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

- the degree to which the instructions have been followed,
- the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,
- the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and
- the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on William Shakespeare's Sonnet 34

Literary concepts that **MIGHT** be used by the contestant in a discussion of the speaker's shift in tone in William Shakespeare's "[Why didst thou promise such a beauteous day]" include

- assonance,
- apostrophe,
- chiasmus,
- consonance,
- denotation,
- diction,
- elision,
- epiphany,
- metaphor,
- rhetorical question,
- rhyme scheme,
- sigmatism,
- tone, and
- volta.

The contestant should recognize a logical—bordering on emotional—turn that characterizes the sonnet's concluding couplet. Recognition of an implied epiphany—arguably on either the speaker's or the listener's/the lover's part—in the "Ah!" (line 13) might inform the contestant's analysis.

The sonnet's third quatrain suggests a possibility that the lover/offender is aware of the pain they have caused/are causing and, perhaps, that the offender is sorrowful (line 11).

The final two lines frame something in the way of a forgiving of the offender for their display of tears.